ENGLISH C1 · ADVANCED GRAMMAR

Ellipsis for cohesion

Omit repeated verb phrases and clause material when auxiliaries and discourse context make the missing content recoverable. The lesson connects form, meaning, register and real editorial decisions rather than treating the pattern as an isolated rule.

THE CENTRAL IDEA

Use ellipsis for cohesion to create natural economy while preserving a single clear antecedent while preserving the intended meaning and register.

Omit repeated verb phrases and clause material when auxiliaries and discourse context make the missing content recoverable.

MODEL

Maya can analyse the data, and Leo can too.

auxiliary/modal + recoverable gap | coordinated clause ellipsis

6 GUIDED STAGES · 30 LEARNING DECISIONS

This complete guide combines explanation, visual reasoning, practice and feedback. Separate exercise and answer-key editions are also available from the lesson page.

LEARNING OUTCOMES

OUTCOME 1

01

Recognise the main ellipsis for cohesion patterns in authentic contexts.

OUTCOME 2

02

Choose a form that accurately expresses create natural economy while preserving a single clear antecedent.

OUTCOME 3

03

Avoid errors that change time, agency, emphasis or speaker commitment.

OUTCOME 4

04

Use the structure appropriately in conversation, comparison, coordinated prose and concise responses.

Build meaning before form

Omit repeated verb phrases and clause material when auxiliaries and discourse context make the missing content recoverable.

What ellipsis for cohesion communicates

Omit repeated verb phrases and clause material when auxiliaries and discourse context make the missing content recoverable.

The central purpose is to create natural economy while preserving a single clear antecedent. A successful choice therefore preserves the proposition while making the intended relationship, viewpoint or degree of commitment visible to the reader.

Maya can analyse the data, and Leo can too.	a repeated verb phrase recovered after an auxiliary
The second trial performed better than the first did.	a comparison with repeated predicate material omitted
Some participants chose the online option; others, the workshop.	a repeated verb omitted in a parallel coordinate

How the pattern is built

Use this working formula: auxiliary/modal + recoverable gap | coordinated clause ellipsis. The formula is a decision path: it identifies the trigger, the clause architecture and the element that carries tense or modality.

The model “Maya can analyse the data, and Leo can too.” shows the complete pattern in context. Rebuild the sentence from meaning to form instead of translating each word independently.

Choice	Structure	Example
Auxiliary ellipsis	auxiliary/modal + omitted verb phrase	Maya can analyse the data, and Leo can too.
Comparative ellipsis	than/as + reduced clause	The second trial performed better than the first did.
Coordinated omission	shared element omitted from second coordinate	Some participants chose the online option; others, the workshop.

Choose by meaning, not by surface similarity

Neighbouring structures may contain similar words but perform different jobs. Compare the three reference patterns and name the intended effect before completing the sentence.

A reliable answer explains both why the chosen form works and why a plausible alternative would change the meaning, time relation, information focus or level of certainty.

Meaning	Best route
a repeated verb phrase recovered after an auxiliary	Auxiliary ellipsis
a comparison with repeated predicate material omitted	Comparative ellipsis
a repeated verb omitted in a parallel coordinate	Coordinated omission

Register, discourse and editorial control

This grammar is especially useful in conversation, comparison, coordinated prose and concise responses. Its value comes from helping the reader process a relationship efficiently, not from making the sentence sound artificially complex.

After editing, check recoverability, natural word order and consistency with the surrounding paragraph. If the marked structure creates ambiguity, return to a fuller or more neutral clause.

Reason through the pattern

The visual map moves from communicative purpose to structural trigger, then to the final clause. It keeps meaning and form visible at the same time so the learner can justify every choice.

01	02	03
auxiliary/modal	recoverable gap	coordinated clause ellipsis

DECIDE IN THIS ORDER

STEP 1

Decision 1

Identify the communicative purpose before selecting a form: create natural economy while preserving a single clear antecedent.

STEP 2

Decision 2

Locate the structural trigger and match it to one of the reference patterns.

STEP 3

Decision 3

Check time reference, clause relationships, agency and speaker commitment.

STEP 4

Decision 4

Read the complete sentence in context and confirm that its register suits conversation, comparison, coordinated prose and concise responses.

STEP 5

Decision 5

Compare the result with a neutral alternative and keep the marked form only when it adds useful meaning.

Compare forms and meanings

Use the table to justify each structural choice.

Pattern	Form	Model
Auxiliary ellipsis	auxiliary/modal + omitted verb phrase	Maya can analyse the data, and Leo can too.
Comparative ellipsis	than/as + reduced clause	The second trial performed better than the first did.
Coordinated omission	shared element omitted from second coordinate	Some participants chose the online option; others, the workshop.

EXAMPLES AT A GLANCE

Maya can analyse the data, and Leo can too.	a repeated verb phrase recovered after an auxiliary
The second trial performed better than the first did.	a comparison with repeated predicate material omitted
Some participants chose the online option; others, the workshop.	a repeated verb omitted in a parallel coordinate

COMMON ERRORS

EDIT THIS

Avoid this pattern

Do not omit material if more than one antecedent could fill the gap.

EDIT THIS

Avoid this pattern

Do not remove the auxiliary when it is needed to show tense or agreement.

EDIT THIS

Avoid this pattern

Use punctuation and parallel structure to keep the omission recoverable.

Recognition in context

Choose the sentence whose grammar matches the stated communicative purpose.

A1 · MEANING DECISION 1

Which sentence best communicates this purpose: a repeated verb phrase recovered after an auxiliary?

OPTIONS Maya can analyse the data, and Leo can too. · The second trial performed better than the first did. · Some participants chose the online option; others, the workshop.

A2 · MEANING DECISION 2

Which sentence best communicates this purpose: a comparison with repeated predicate material omitted?

OPTIONS The second trial performed better than the first did. · Some participants chose the online option; others, the workshop. · Maya can analyse the data, and Leo can too.

A3 · MEANING DECISION 3

Which sentence best communicates this purpose: a repeated verb omitted in a parallel coordinate?

OPTIONS Some participants chose the online option; others, the workshop. · Maya can analyse the data, and Leo can too. · The second trial performed better than the first did.

A4 · INTERPRETATION 4

What does “Maya can analyse the data, and Leo can too.” communicate in this context?

OPTIONS a repeated verb phrase recovered after an auxiliary · a comparison with repeated predicate material omitted · a repeated verb omitted in a parallel coordinate

A5 · INTERPRETATION 5

What does “The second trial performed better than the first did.” communicate in this context?

OPTIONS a comparison with repeated predicate material omitted · a repeated verb omitted in a parallel coordinate · a repeated verb phrase recovered after an auxiliary

A6 · INTERPRETATION 6

What does “Some participants chose the online option; others, the workshop.” communicate in this context?

OPTIONS a repeated verb omitted in a parallel coordinate · a repeated verb phrase recovered after an auxiliary · a comparison with repeated predicate material omitted

STAGE CHECK

Pause before continuing

Underline the trigger or decision point, name the rule, and check that the meaning has not changed.

Form and function

Identify both the structural family and the meaning carried by each model.

B1 · FORM AND FUNCTION 1

“Maya can analyse the data, and Leo can too.” uses _____ to express _____.

OPTIONS Gap 1: Auxiliary ellipsis / Comparative ellipsis / Coordinated omission · Gap 2: a repeated verb phrase recovered after an auxiliary / a comparison with repeated predicate material omitted / a repeated verb omitted in a parallel coordinate

B2 · FORM AND FUNCTION 2

“The second trial performed better than the first did.” uses _____ to express _____.

OPTIONS Gap 1: Comparative ellipsis / Coordinated omission / Auxiliary ellipsis · Gap 2: a comparison with repeated predicate material omitted / a repeated verb omitted in a parallel coordinate / a repeated verb phrase recovered after an auxiliary

B3 · FORM AND FUNCTION 3

“Some participants chose the online option; others, the workshop.” uses _____ to express _____.

OPTIONS Gap 1: Coordinated omission / Auxiliary ellipsis / Comparative ellipsis · Gap 2: a repeated verb omitted in a parallel coordinate / a repeated verb phrase recovered after an auxiliary / a comparison with repeated predicate material omitted

STAGE CHECK

Pause before continuing

Underline the trigger or decision point, name the rule, and check that the meaning has not changed.

Guided discourse choices

Maintain accurate form and meaning across a connected sequence of decisions.

C1 · EDITORIAL PLANNING

Choose the model that expresses a repeated verb phrase recovered after an auxiliary: _____. Choose the model that expresses a comparison with repeated predicate material omitted: _____. Choose the model that expresses a repeated verb omitted in a parallel coordinate: _____. Choose the model built with auxiliary/modal + omitted verb phrase: _____. Choose the model built with than/as + reduced clause: _____. Choose the model built with shared element omitted from second coordinate: _____.

_____
_____

WORD BANK

Available forms

Maya can analyse the data, and Leo can too. · Some participants chose the online option; others, the workshop. · The second trial performed better than the first did.

STAGE CHECK

Pause before continuing

Underline the trigger or decision point, name the rule, and check that the meaning has not changed.

04 · PRACTICE STAGE

Open reconstruction

Recover the missing structural trigger without a word bank.

D1 · INDEPENDENT RECONSTRUCTION

Maya can analyse the data, and _____. The second trial performed better _____. Some participants chose the online option; _____. State the full structural pattern for Auxiliary ellipsis: _____. State the full structural pattern for Comparative ellipsis: _____.

_____
_____
_____
_____

STAGE CHECK

Pause before continuing

Underline the trigger or decision point, name the rule, and check that the meaning has not changed.

Controlled transformation

Rewrite the neutral source so that it performs the requested advanced function.

E1 · TRANSFORMATION 1

Rewrite “Maya and Leo can both analyse the data.” using the Auxiliary ellipsis pattern to express a repeated verb phrase recovered after an auxiliary.

_____
_____

E2 · TRANSFORMATION 2

Rewrite “The second trial outperformed the first trial.” using the Comparative ellipsis pattern to express a comparison with repeated predicate material omitted.

_____
_____

E3 · TRANSFORMATION 3

Rewrite “Some chose online; others chose the workshop.” using the Coordinated omission pattern to express a repeated verb omitted in a parallel coordinate.

_____
_____

E4 · TRANSFORMATION 4

Rewrite “Maya and Leo can both analyse the data.” using the Auxiliary ellipsis pattern to express a repeated verb phrase recovered after an auxiliary.

_____
_____

STAGE CHECK

Pause before continuing

Underline the trigger or decision point, name the rule, and check that the meaning has not changed.

Communicative production

Use the grammar independently in realistic academic, professional and conversational contexts.

F1 · PRODUCTION TASK 1

Write two connected sentences about a realistic situation. Use Auxiliary ellipsis to express a repeated verb phrase recovered after an auxiliary, then add a neutral sentence that makes the contrast clear.

_____
_____
_____

F2 · PRODUCTION TASK 2

Write two connected sentences about a realistic situation. Use Comparative ellipsis to express a comparison with repeated predicate material omitted, then add a neutral sentence that makes the contrast clear.

_____
_____
_____

F3 · PRODUCTION TASK 3

Write two connected sentences about a realistic situation. Use Coordinated omission to express a repeated verb omitted in a parallel coordinate, then add a neutral sentence that makes the contrast clear.

_____
_____
_____

Final self-check

Complete these prompts without reopening the guide.

R1 · REVIEW FOCUS

Explain and exemplify: communicative purpose.

_____
_____
_____

R2 · REVIEW FOCUS

Explain and exemplify: structural trigger.

_____
_____
_____

R3 · REVIEW FOCUS

Explain and exemplify: meaning contrast.

_____
_____
_____

R4 · REVIEW FOCUS

Explain and exemplify: register choice.

_____
_____
_____

Recognition in context

Compare the form first, then read the explanation and name the rule in your own words.

A1

Maya can analyse the data, and Leo can too.

Auxiliary ellipsis is the best match because a repeated verb phrase recovered after an auxiliary.

A2

The second trial performed better than the first did.

Comparative ellipsis is the best match because a comparison with repeated predicate material omitted.

A3

Some participants chose the online option; others, the workshop.

Coordinated omission is the best match because a repeated verb omitted in a parallel coordinate.

A4

a repeated verb phrase recovered after an auxiliary

The Auxiliary ellipsis pattern communicates a repeated verb phrase recovered after an auxiliary.

A5

a comparison with repeated predicate material omitted

The Comparative ellipsis pattern communicates a comparison with repeated predicate material omitted.

A6

a repeated verb omitted in a parallel coordinate

The Coordinated omission pattern communicates a repeated verb omitted in a parallel coordinate.

Form and function

Compare the form first, then read the explanation and name the rule in your own words.

B1

Auxiliary ellipsis / a repeated verb phrase recovered after an auxiliary

The structure belongs to the Auxiliary ellipsis pattern. Its communicative purpose is a repeated verb phrase recovered after an auxiliary.

B2

Comparative ellipsis / a comparison with repeated predicate material omitted

The structure belongs to the Comparative ellipsis pattern. Its communicative purpose is a comparison with repeated predicate material omitted.

B3

Coordinated omission / a repeated verb omitted in a parallel coordinate

The structure belongs to the Coordinated omission pattern. Its communicative purpose is a repeated verb omitted in a parallel coordinate.

Guided discourse choices

Compare the form first, then read the explanation and name the rule in your own words.

C1

Maya can analyse the data, and Leo can too.

Auxiliary ellipsis: auxiliary/modal + omitted verb phrase.

C2

The second trial performed better than the first did.

Comparative ellipsis: than/as + reduced clause.

C3

Some participants chose the online option; others, the workshop.

Coordinated omission: shared element omitted from second coordinate.

C4

Maya can analyse the data, and Leo can too.

Auxiliary ellipsis: auxiliary/modal + omitted verb phrase.

C5

The second trial performed better than the first did.

Comparative ellipsis: than/as + reduced clause.

C6

Some participants chose the online option; others, the workshop.

Coordinated omission: shared element omitted from second coordinate.

Open reconstruction

Compare the form first, then read the explanation and name the rule in your own words.

D1

Leo can too

Auxiliary ellipsis requires “Leo can too” in this model. auxiliary/modal + omitted verb phrase.

D2

than the first did

Comparative ellipsis requires “than the first did” in this model. than/as + reduced clause.

D3

others, the workshop

Coordinated omission requires “others, the workshop” in this model. shared element omitted from second coordinate.

D4

auxiliary/modal + omitted verb phrase

Auxiliary ellipsis is built as auxiliary/modal + omitted verb phrase.

D5

than/as + reduced clause

Comparative ellipsis is built as than/as + reduced clause.

Controlled transformation

Compare the form first, then read the explanation and name the rule in your own words.

E1

Maya can analyse the data, and Leo can too.

auxiliary/modal + omitted verb phrase. The rewrite preserves the core message while adding the intended auxiliary ellipsis effect.

E2

The second trial performed better than the first did.

than/as + reduced clause. The rewrite preserves the core message while adding the intended comparative ellipsis effect.

E3

Some participants chose the online option; others, the workshop.

shared element omitted from second coordinate. The rewrite preserves the core message while adding the intended coordinated omission effect.

E4

Maya can analyse the data, and Leo can too.

auxiliary/modal + omitted verb phrase. The rewrite preserves the core message while adding the intended auxiliary ellipsis effect.

Communicative production

Compare the form first, then read the explanation and name the rule in your own words.

F1

Maya can analyse the data, and Leo can too. The surrounding context would then state the same situation in neutral order or with a less marked commitment.

A strong response uses auxiliary/modal + omitted verb phrase accurately and makes the communicative purpose visible in context.

F2

The second trial performed better than the first did. The surrounding context would then state the same situation in neutral order or with a less marked commitment.

A strong response uses than/as + reduced clause accurately and makes the communicative purpose visible in context.

F3

Some participants chose the online option; others, the workshop. The surrounding context would then state the same situation in neutral order or with a less marked commitment.

A strong response uses shared element omitted from second coordinate accurately and makes the communicative purpose visible in context.

Diagnose the pattern, not only the score

Use this page to decide what to revisit in the complete guide.

CHECK · TRIGGER OR CONTEXT

What went wrong? What rule will prevent the same error next time?

_____
_____
_____

CHECK · AUXILIARY OR STRUCTURAL CHOICE

What went wrong? What rule will prevent the same error next time?

_____
_____
_____

CHECK · MAIN VERB OR CLAUSE FORM

What went wrong? What rule will prevent the same error next time?

_____
_____
_____

CHECK · MEANING AND REGISTER

What went wrong? What rule will prevent the same error next time?

_____
_____
_____